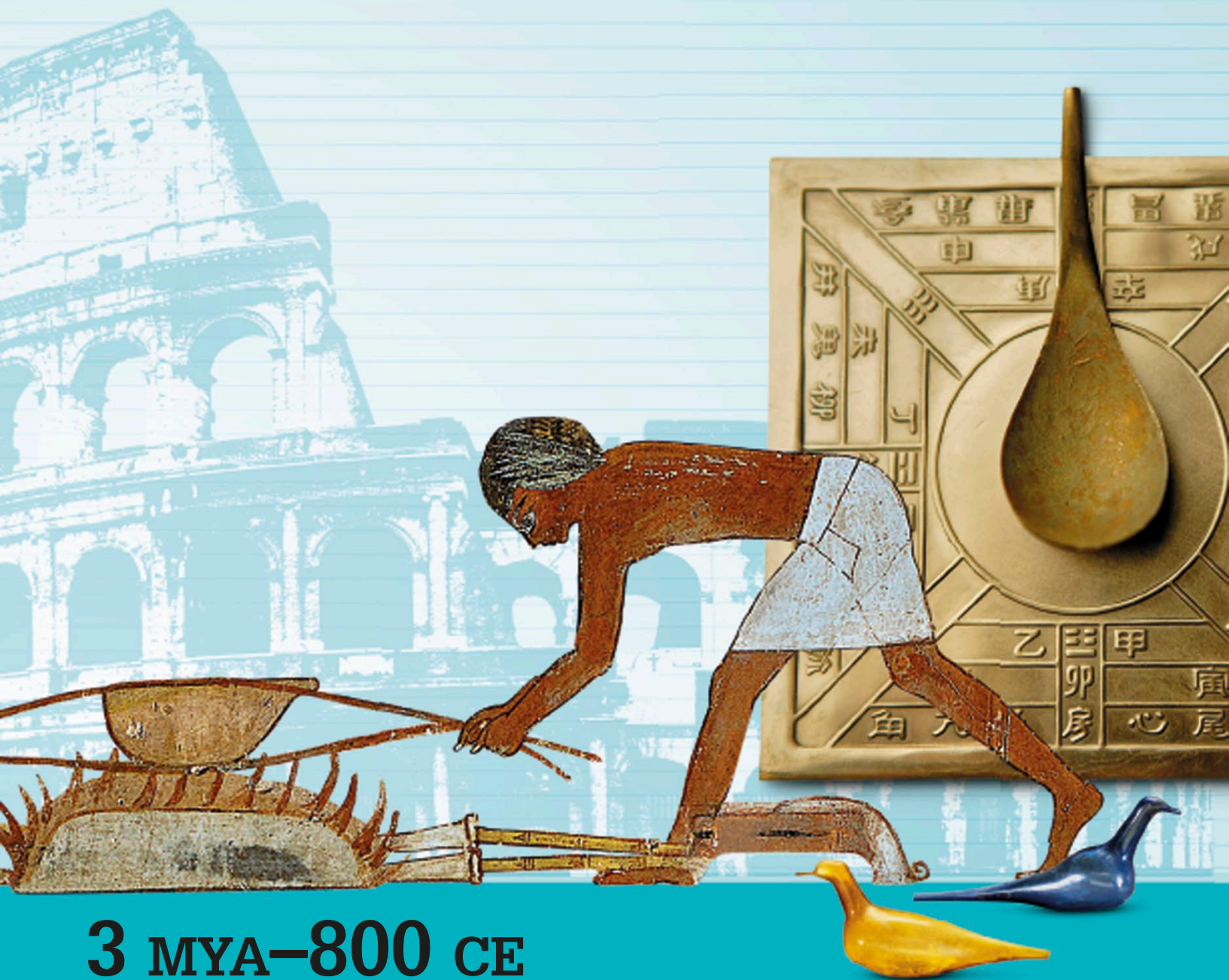




3 MYA–800 CE

Before science began

The earliest scientific discoveries of our ancestors—such as the use of fire and the start of farming—happened long before the first civilizations arose around 4000 BCE. Once people became settled, the pace of change quickened. The Babylonians made advances in astronomy, the Greeks developed medicine and mathematics, and the Romans led the way in engineering. After the fall of the Western Roman Empire in 476 CE, however, much scientific knowledge was lost for centuries.